Ji Soo Lee

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Personal Profile

A Ph.D. student at the Machine Learning and Vision (MLV) Lab of KAIST, advised by Prof. Hyunwoo J. Kim. I received my MS from the same lab and my BS in Computer Science and Engineering from Korea University. My research focuses on advancing **multi-modal understanding and reasoning** with foundation models, with an emphasis on **post-training** (preference optimization and reasoning distillation) and on **agentic AI** (skill and harness optimization).

Education

PhD	**KAIST** School of Computing (SoC), Computer Science and Engineering	March 2026 -
MS	**Korea University** College of Informatics, Computer Science and Engineering	Sept 2023 – Feb 2026
BS	**Korea University** College of Informatics, Computer Science and Engineering	March 2019 – Aug 2023
HS	**International School of Prague** Prague, Czech Republic (High School)	Apr 2015 - May 2018

- International Baccalaureate (IB)
- High-Level subjects: Physics, Computer Science and Mathematics
- Standard Level subjects: Economics, Spanish and English

Publications

Reason in the Words You Speak: Idiolectal Paraphrasing Off-Policy Traces for Reasoning Distillation in VideoLLMs — NeurIPS 2026

Ji Soo Lee, Jinyoung Park, Seohyun Lee, Jongha Kim, Joonmyung Choi, Jinsung Yoon, Hyunwoo J Kim
Collaboration w/ Google Cloud AI Research

WearableQA: A Benchmark for Health Reasoning over Real-World Wearable Data — Preprint (UnderReview)

Ji Soo Lee*, Xilun Chen*, Pierce Chuang, Ashish Shenoy, Jason Wei, Dohwan Ko, Hyunwoo J Kim, Benoit Corda
Collaboration w/ Meta

Retrieval-Augmented Skill Optimization via Cross-Harness Adaptation — Preprint (UnderReview)

Jaewon Chu, **Ji Soo Lee**, Jihwan Park, Dohwan Ko, Jeehye Na, Seunghun Lee, Taehoon Lee, Minseo Yoon, Minseok Joo, Yunyang Xiong, Hyunwoo J Kim
Collaboration w/ Meta

MMEnterprise-Bench: Evaluating Enterprise Agents over Evolving Multimodal Records — Preprint (UnderReview)

Seohyun Lee, Jongha Kim, Dohwan Ko, **Ji Soo Lee**, Seoung Choi, Jayun Ku, Hyunwoo J Kim

SuperClip Pyramid for Video Temporal Grounding — Preprint (UnderReview)

Sanghyeok Lee, Juyeon Ko, Joonmyung Choi, Jongha Kim, Dohwan Ko, **Ji Soo Lee**, Hyunwoo J Kim
Collaboration w/ KT

SVMemAgent: A Streaming Video Memory Agent for Query-Agnostic Online Frame Selection — ECCV 2026 (Workshop)
Dohwan Ko, **Ji Soo Lee**, Pierce Chuang, Debojeet Chatterjee, Ashish Shenoy, Yichao Lu, Seungwhan Moon, Xin Luna Dong, Vikas Bhardwaj, Hyunwoo J Kim
Collaboration w/ Meta

Captioning for Text-Video Retrieval via Dual-Group Direct Preference Optimization — EMNLP 2025 (Findings)
Ji Soo Lee, Byungoh Ko, Jaewon Cho, Howoong Lee, Jaewoon Byun, Hyunwoo J Kim.
Collaboration w/ Hanwha

Bidirectional Likelihood Estimation with Multi-Modal Large Language Models for Text-Video Retrieval — ICCV 2025 (Highlight)
Dohwan Ko*, **Ji Soo Lee***, Minhyuk Choi, Zihang Meng, Hyunwoo J Kim
Collaboration w/ Meta

VidChain: Chain-of-Tasks with Metric-based Direct Preference Optimization for Dense Video Captioning — AAAI 2025
Ji Soo Lee*, Jongha Kim*, Jeehye Na, Jinyoung Park, Hyunwoo J Kim

Large Language Models are Temporal and Causal Reasoners for Video Question Answering — EMNLP 2023
Dohwan Ko*, **Ji Soo Lee***, Wooyoung Kang, Byungseok Roh, Hyunwoo J Kim

Open-vocabulary Video Question Answering: A New Benchmark for Evaluating the Generalizability of Video Question Answering Models — ICCV 2023
Dohwan Ko, **Ji Soo Lee**, Miso Choi, Jaewon Chu, Jihwan Park, Hyunwoo J Kim

Experience

Meta, Research Intern, Reality Labs — Menlo Park, CA
April 2026 - July 2026
- Health Reasoning over Real-World Wearable Data
- **Manager**: Pierce Chuang
- **Team**: Xilun Chen, Benoit Corda, Ashish Shenoy, Jason Wei

MLV Lab, Research Intern — Seoul, Korea
April 2022 - Aug 2023
- Computer Vision, Foundation models, Multi-modal

SATUS, Junior Software Engineer — Seoul, Korea
Sept 2020 - Aug 2022
- Developed, maintained, and shipped production code for client websites
- *e.g.*, Home Website, Intranet, Student Planner

SATUS, Teacher Assistant / Tutor — Seoul, Korea
June 2019 - Aug 2021
- International Baccalaureate(IB) curriculum
- **Fields**: Computer Science, Physics, Mathematics, Economics

SKILLS

920/990 TOEIC (ETS) — 2025

DELE A2 (Instituto Cervantes) — 2018

111/120 TOEFL (ETS) — 2018

Achievements

Travel Award, International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV) 2023

Academic Excellence Freshman scholarship, Korea University 2023

Data Science with Python, Byte Degree, Fast Campus (certificate) 2020

Languages

Korean Fluent
English Fluent
Spanish Elementary